YoungJoo Kang

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SUMMARY

AI Safety and Evaluation practitioner combining hands-on red-teaming, RLHF, and SFT experience with a 10+ year background in B2B enterprise operations. Specializes in assessing whether model outputs align with defined behavioral specifications, evaluating the reasoning behind each judgment rather than surface output compliance, and identifying structural gaps in evaluation guidelines. Maps how safety judgments shift when language, culture, and context combine in unstructured environments, surfacing contextual vulnerabilities invisible to English-centric evaluation frameworks.

INDEPENDENT RESEARCH

Public Comment on NIST AI 300-1 ipd (Public-Facing AI Documentation) Sep 2026

- Proposed field-level additions to the dataset documentation template from first-hand annotation experience: the state of guidelines per language, and the conditions of agreement measurement.
- Attached field drafts for post-deployment model updates as the seed of a specialized profile.

Korean Speech Annotation: Where the Guideline Runs Out Jun 2026

- Built, verified, and bounded judgment criteria across ten annotation cases where an English-based guideline met spoken Korean and turned ambiguous or empty.
- Documented reasoning-layer edge cases in traceable form and generalized the resulting criteria into a domain-transferable methodology for judgment framework design.
- Identified three cross-case structural patterns (capability independence, the dependency structure of consistency, and the separation of validity and verification) that serve as reusable principles for judgment framework design.

stop-bluff: Open-source Input Integrity Protocol for LLMs Jun 2026

- Developed an open-source governance protocol to mitigate structural LLM vulnerabilities, specifically completion bias and sycophancy, preventing models from silently bypassing missing inputs or inferring undefined terms.
- Designed a strict four-part behavioral guardrail (Input Verification, Honesty Obligation, Confirmation Gate, Self-Contained Return) that forces the AI to halt processing and explicitly request user validation when data mismatches occur.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TOOLS

- **AI Safety & Evaluation:** Red Teaming, LLM Evaluation (RLHF), SFT Data Annotation, Annotation Quality Control, Prompt Engineering
- **Methodology & Frameworks:** Judgment Framework Design, Multi-layered Rubric Application, Cross-cultural & Legal Context Analysis, Annotation Consistency Review
- **Technical Tools:** Python (Foundational), Excel
- **Languages:** Korean (Native), English (Professional)

AI SAFETY & EVALUATION EXPERIENCE

Independent AI Safety & Data Annotation Contractor Oct 2025 – Present

Mercor, Turing | Remote

Conducted AI training data annotation and evaluation across adversarial safety, reasoning integrity, and data quality, spanning Korean and English across multiple model types and task formats.

- **Safety Alignment Data Pipeline** (Korean): Advanced through all three stages of a safety data project, from adversarial prompt writing to RLHF review and audit to SFT-level response revision, targeting Korean-language-specific patterns and culturally embedded edge cases across sensitive and harmful categories at every stage.
- **Reasoning & Alignment Evaluation** (English): Evaluated AI-generated legal responses for reasoning integrity, identifying subtle logical flaws and misapplied legal principles across complex prompts.
- **SFT Data Authoring** (Korean): Wrote and localized prompt-response pairs for general-domain SFT; identified structural gaps in Korean language conventions and cross-lingual consistency, including honorific register mismatches and translationese syntax.

- **Speech Data Annotation & QA** (Korean): Transcribed and annotated spontaneous multi-speaker conversational Korean audio, including non-verbal cues, and reviewed transcriptions against project QA standards.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

APJ Enterprise Excellence Program Manager Jan 2022 – Aug 2023
Amazon Web Services Korea | Seoul, Korea

- Designed and maintained enterprise account planning and customer journey frameworks across 50+ APJ accounts, mapping cross-functional engagement touchpoints to reduce customer fatigue and enable coordinated, one-voice go-to-market execution.
- Led opportunity review process across enterprise accounts, providing structured analysis of pipeline health and execution readiness to support sales decision-making.

Business Strategy & Operations Analyst Feb 2019 – Dec 2021
VMware Korea | Seoul, Korea

- Designed and built the Account Potential Framework: a structured model for calculating each enterprise account's total addressable buying power using IT landscape data, employee count, device inventory, install-base, and competitive displacement estimates. Logic was cross-validated with relevant functional team leads and adopted by sales teams as the basis for account planning.
- Translated market signals, customer insights, and performance data into actionable guidance for sales and solution teams; maintained enterprise dashboards and planning tools to support real-time performance tracking across regional stakeholders.

Business Strategy & Operations Analyst Apr 2018 – Feb 2019
Oracle Korea | Seoul, Korea

- Supported APAC channel leadership with structured partner performance tracking, compliance monitoring, and engagement planning. Translating performance data into actionable inputs for regional partner strategy.

Inside Sales Representative Sep 2013 – Apr 2018
Oracle Korea | Seoul, Korea

- Managed full SMB sales cycle for cloud-based solutions: account segmentation by size and upsell potential, campaign-driven pipeline development using install-base and marketing data, and co-selling coordination with Field Sales Representatives.
- Achieved Annual Quota Attainment across multiple years within a shared-territory model, supporting field sales logistics and internal approval processes alongside direct pipeline development.

Solution Sales Associate Sep 2010 – Apr 2013
Futures Brain Co., Ltd | Seoul, Korea

- Built cross-border partnerships and guided clients on compliance and localization requirements for IT-financial product integration.

Sales & Marketing Associate Jan 2008 – Jul 2009
Korea Exchange Bank Futures | Seoul, Korea

- Promoted derivative financial products and managed private investor relationships; supported marketing and PR for client-facing events.

EDUCATION

LL.M. in International Legal Studies Aug 2009 – May 2010
American University Washington College of Law | Washington D.C., USA

- Embassy of the Republic of Korea & PILPG: researched U.S. congressional foreign policy and post-conflict peace building during LL.M. year.

LL.M. coursework in International Law Aug 2008 – Aug 2009
Yonsei University Graduate School of Law | Seoul, Korea

B.A. in International Studies Mar 2004 – Feb 2008
Korea University, Division of International Studies | Seoul, Korea

CERTIFICATIONS

Google AI Essentials · **Google Career Certificate** Nov 2025

ChatGPT Prompt Engineering for Developers · **DeepLearning.AI & OpenAI** Aug 2025